

## USB Speakers

A Laptop usually comes with a set of speakers that are just barely acceptable. If you have a laptop with speakers from JBL or Altec Lansing, you are probably not going to need USB speakers. You would only need them if you want your laptop to amuse your ears from more than a couple meters away.

If you want to listen to music at higher volumes in your living space, it would be better to get a 2.1 channel subwoofer speaker set than USB speakers. USB speakers draw power from your laptop and that would result in shorter backup time. They are recommended only if you want to game or play multimedia on the go and your laptop's built-in speakers do not meet your expectations.

## Pen Drives

Not necessarily a 'Laptop' accessory, they serve multiple purposes from taking quick document printouts to handy backups. If data privacy is your concern, you can use one of the many device encryption software available in the market (e.g. TrueCrypt) or just go with Windows' own BitLocker. They can also contain an alternate OS (e.g. a Live Linux OS) to help you boot into a recovery environment before you launch the factory-reset wizard. It's one of the most useful accessories and a must-have.

## Mouse

If you think your touchpad is a good replacement for a mouse, wait until you try editing a picture. Even if you are not a graphics designer, a mouse comes in handy when you need to work fast. From small actions such as switching windows, scrolling, zooming, opening file properties to video editing, gaming and image editing, a mouse is immensely useful. Depending on your dislike towards wires and the weight of your wallet, you might also want to opt for a wireless one.

## Webcam

Quite obviously, if you need this, your laptop is too old and it's advisable that you get a new one. Most new laptops come with a webcam built above the screen to help you video chat or just click a picture. Portable webcams are useful if and only if you are not ready to replace your age-old laptop with a new one or, through some extremely foolish act of carelessness, you damaged the one on your existing laptop, and still want to be able to video chat with buddies.